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THE FINAL

McGill | École Bensadoun de commerce au détail
Bensadoun School of Retail Management

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DATA
SPHERE
LAB

OCTOBER 15TH AND 16TH

WHAT TO EXPECT IN THE FINAL 2-DAY EVENT OCT 15TH AND 16TH

During the 2-day Final, you will need to develop your idea to the next level, develop a working prototype and pitch before a Jury Panel.

Oct 15th : 10:00AM Bronfman 2nd floor - all teams for the kick off, registration, swag, meet your mentors , AWS access and begin hacking at your pod stations.
Oct 16th morning : Hacking continues until 2PM

OCT 16TH AFTERNOON FINAL PRESENTATION :

Presentation Output: 8-minute presentation per team + 1 Question from Jury Panel
Number of Slides: No slide limit.

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DELIVERABLES:

1 - PROBLEM AND THESIS

Clearly explain:

- What problem or opportunity did you identify?
- Who or what is affected?
- Why does it matter?
- Why is the current approach insufficient?
- What is your thesis for improving gross margin and/or customer satisfaction?

2- AGENTIC APPROACH

Show:

- What the agent knows
- What it is trying to accomplish
- What decisions it makes
- What tools, data or systems it can access
- What actions it can take
- Where human intervention remains appropriate

3 - WORKING PROTOTYPE

- Demonstrate at least one end-to-end scenario.
- The prototype should make the agent's reasoning, decisions and actions visible enough to understand how the solution works.

4- BUSINESS IMPACT

- Quantify or estimate the potential impact of the solution.
- Teams should select the measures most relevant to their own thesis rather than optimize against a predefined set of KPIs.

5- RESPONSIBLE AI

Explain the risks associated with giving the proposed agent autonomy and how those risks would be managed.
Consider issues such as:

- Customer fairness
- Privacy
- Bias
- Explainability
- Financial authority
- Appropriate human oversight

FINAL PRESENTATION JUDGING CRITERIA

BUSINESS IMPACT & STRENGTH OF THESIS — 30%

- Has the team identified a meaningful problem or opportunity?
- Is there a compelling and well-supported thesis for why the proposed solution creates value?
- Is there a credible path to protecting gross margin and/or improving customer satisfaction?

AGENTIC INNOVATION — 25%

- Does the solution genuinely take advantage of autonomous reasoning and action?
- Would a traditional rules engine, analytics model or chatbot accomplish essentially the same thing?

SCALABILITY AND FEASIBILITY — 15%

- Could this concept realistically operate at retail scale?

PRESENTATION — 15%

- Is the solution clearly explained and convincingly demonstrated?

TECHNICAL EXECUTION - 15%

- How effectively does the prototype demonstrate the concept?